

Global AI Usage Report

How Many People Are Using Artificial Intelligence?

March 2026 · Comprehensive Global Analysis

This report synthesizes the latest data from DataReportal, Microsoft AI Economy Institute, McKinsey, Stanford HAI, Grand View Research, DemandSage, and dozens of additional primary sources to provide a comprehensive picture of artificial intelligence adoption worldwide.

1. Global AI User Base

As of early 2026, artificial intelligence has crossed a historic milestone: over **1.35–1.5 billion people** actively use AI tools each month — roughly **16.3 % of the world's population** and approximately one in five internet users. Despite this rapid ascent, around 5 billion internet users have yet to adopt AI, underscoring that the technology remains in the early stages of mass diffusion.

1.4 B+ Monthly Active AI Users Globally	16.3 % Share of World Population	5 B+ Internet Users Not Yet Using AI
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For context, social-media platforms took more than a decade to achieve comparable user numbers. Standalone AI tools — led by ChatGPT — reached this threshold in roughly **three years**, a rate of adoption unprecedented in the history of consumer technology.

2. AI Adoption by Region & Country

Adoption rates vary enormously across geographies. Emerging-market nations — particularly in South and South-East Asia and the Middle East — are adopting AI faster than more mature economies, driven by mobile-first internet access and younger demographic profiles.

Top Countries by AI Adoption Rate (Working-Age Population)

Country / Region	Adoption Rate	Notable Context
India	~73 %	Fastest absolute growth; 4× wealthier nations' pace
UAE	64.0 %	Highest adoption in the Middle East
Singapore	60.9 %	Asia-Pacific leader
Chile	~60 %	Latin America leader
South Korea	~30 %	+80 % YoY — fastest growth rate globally
EU Average	32.7 %	Individuals aged 16–74

USA	28.3 %	77.2 M monthly ChatGPT users
UK	~29 %	Strong enterprise uptake
China	~83 %*	*Awareness metric; ChatGPT blocked — 250 M domestic users

Sources: DataReportal Digital 2026; Microsoft AI Economy Institute; AllAboutAI Global Adoption Index.

Regional Market Share

Region	2025 Market Share	Growth (CAGR)	Outlook
North America	36.9 %	~17 %	Dominant today; incremental gains
Asia-Pacific	33.0 %	19.8 %	Expected to dominate by 2030 (~47 %)
Europe	~18 %	~16 %	Regulatory environment shaping pace
Rest of World	~12 %	~21 %	Fastest-growing but smallest base

Note: Global North adoption rate 24.7 %; Global South 14.1 % — gap widening.

3. Leading AI Platforms & User Counts

ChatGPT — launched in November 2022 — remains by far the most-used AI platform, accounting for roughly 80 % of the AI chatbot market. However, competition from Google, Microsoft, Anthropic, and a wave of domestic Asian models is intensifying.

Platform	Monthly Active Users	Key Metric	Market Share
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	~1 B MAU / 900 M WAU	5.72 B web visits/mo; 2.5 B prompts/day	~80.5 %
Google Gemini	400–750 M MAU	Integrated in Google Search (2 B+ users)	~21.5 % (global)
Microsoft Copilot	~101 M users	85 % of Fortune 500 firms	~12.6 % (AI search)
Anthropic Claude	~30 M MAU	25 B API calls/month	~4.7 %
Perplexity AI	30–40 M MAU	30 M daily queries	~6.2 % (US)
DeepSeek	n/a	Domestic China focus	~3.7 %
Grok (xAI)	n/a	X / Twitter integration	~3.4 %

Sources: DemandSage ChatGPT Statistics 2026; First Page Sage Chatbot Market Share Mar 2026; SEOProfy Perplexity Statistics.

Enterprise Reach

- **92 %** of Fortune 500 companies use ChatGPT in some capacity.
- OpenAI holds **7 M+ workplace seats** and **1 M+ business customers**.
- OpenAI's annualised revenue: **\$10 B** (June 2025); valuation: **\$730 B**.
- **78 %** of organisations reported using AI in 2024–25, up from 55 % the prior year (McKinsey State of AI 2025).

4. AI Adoption by Industry

Sector	Adoption Rate	Key Highlights
IT / Telecom	83–85 %	48 % deploying agentic AI (highest); \$4.7 T gross value by 2035
Manufacturing	77 %	23 % avg reduction in downtime; 98 % expect efficiency gains
Education	~86 %*	*Student usage; 92 % use AI for assessments (up from 53 % in 2024)
Healthcare	40 %	CAGR 36.83 %; market \$868 B by 2030; 223 FDA-approved AI devices (2023)
Financial Services	~68 %	\$20 B+ annual AI spending; robo-advisors manage \$1.2 T in assets
Retail / CPG	~47 %	47 % deploying agentic AI; GenAI highest ROI in marketing & sales

Sources: McKinsey State of AI 2025; Mezzi AI Adoption Rates by Industry; NVIDIA State of AI 2026.

71 % of organisations regularly use generative AI in at least one business function, and 86 % of companies plan to increase their AI budgets — with 40 % targeting increases of 10 % or more.

5. Market Size & Growth Projections

\$244 B Global AI Market 2025	\$800 B+ Projected Market 2030	\$19.9 T Cumulative GenAI Economic Impact by 2030
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Metric	2025	2026	2029–2030	CAGR
Global AI Market	\$244 B	\$312 B	\$800 B+	~27 %
Gartner AI Spend	\$1.5 T	\$2.0 T	\$3.3 T	~22 %
Generative AI Market	\$22–64 B	—	\$220–325 B	29–41 %
AI User Base	1.35 B	—	—	~40 %+
AI Platforms Market	—	Growing	+\$101 B	40.5 %

Sources: Grand View Research; Gartner; Master of Code GenAI Statistics.

Workforce Impact

- AI projected to **create 170 M new jobs** while displacing 92 M by 2030 (net positive of 78 M).
- LinkedIn reports a **13× increase** in AI-related job postings over 5 years; talent supply only grew 8×.
- Workers using generative AI save an average of **5.4 % of their work hours** per week.
- Agentic AI expected to resolve **80 % of customer-service issues** autonomously by 2029.

6. Demographics of AI Users

Age Distribution

Age Group	Weekly AI Usage	Notes
Gen Z (18–25)	~70 %	Highest adoption; under-25s = 42 % of ChatGPT's user base
Millennials (26–41)	56 %	Deloitte; 29.7 % of ChatGPT users are aged 25–34
Adults 18–29	46 %	Pew Research
Adults 30–49	~35 %	Moderate usage; workplace-driven
Adults 50–64	~28 %	Growing; productivity focus
Adults 65+	23 %	Lowest adoption; awareness gap key barrier

Sources: TheySaid How Generations Use AI 2026; National University AI Statistics.

Gender Gap

A notable gender divide persists in AI adoption:

- **44 %** of men vs. **33 %** of women report using AI (2024 figures).
- AI awareness gap: 38 % among men vs. 23 % among women.
- In educational settings, the gap narrows significantly: 53 % male vs. 51 % female students use AI.

Education & Socio-Economic Factors

- University-educated individuals: **62 %** report understanding and using AI vs. **40 %** without a degree.
- College-educated daily workplace AI use rose from 22 % → 34 % in one year; non-college-educated use *declined* 6 points — a widening digital divide.
- EU youth (under 30): 44 % use AI for private purposes vs. 25 % of the general population.

7. Key Takeaways

1. **Milestone crossed:** Over 1.4 billion people — roughly 1 in 6 humans — actively use AI tools each month, yet 5 billion internet users have not yet adopted AI.
2. **South beats North:** Emerging markets (India, UAE, Chile) are adopting AI faster than developed economies, driven by mobile access and youthful demographics.
3. **ChatGPT dominates** with ~80 % chatbot market share and ~1 B monthly active users, growing from 300 M weekly actives to 900 M in under 12 months.
4. **Enterprise is all-in:** 78 % of organisations now use AI; 92 % of Fortune 500 companies use ChatGPT; 86 % plan to increase AI budgets.
5. **Economic magnitude:** The global AI market will reach \$800 B+ by 2030, with cumulative generative AI economic impact projected at \$19.9 trillion.
6. **Workforce transformation:** AI will create 170 M new jobs while displacing 92 M — a net positive — but reskilling and bridging the digital divide are critical imperatives.
7. **Demographic divide:** Gen Z leads adoption; a widening gender and education gap risks concentrating AI's benefits among the already privileged.

8. Paid vs. Free User Breakdown

Despite the explosive growth of AI user counts, the vast majority of users remain on free tiers. Monetisation — converting curious free users into paying subscribers — remains the central challenge for AI platforms in 2026.

Paid Subscriber Market Share (Recon Analytics, Jan 2026)

Platform	Paid Share	Est. Paid Users	Price (entry)
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	55.2 %	~15 M+ paying	\$20/mo (Plus)
Google Gemini	15.7 %	Not disclosed	\$19.99/mo (AI Pro)
Microsoft Copilot	11.5 %	~15 M M365 seats	\$30/user/mo
All Others	17.6 %	—	Various

Source: Recon Analytics Paid AI Subscriber Report, January 2026.

Per-Platform Paid vs. Free Detail

Platform	Free Users (~%)	Paid Users (~%)	Key Notes
ChatGPT	~81 %	~19 %*	Plus \$20/mo · Pro \$200/mo · 5M biz users; *among engaged users
Google Gemini	>95 %	<5 %	AI Pro \$19.99/mo · AI Ultra \$249.99/mo; no public paid count
Anthropic Claude	~90 %+	<10 %	Pro \$20 · Max5× \$100 · Max20× \$200; 300K+ biz customers
Microsoft Copilot	96.7 %	3.3 %	3.3% of M365 seats convert to paid Copilot (Feb 2026 earnings)

Free-to-Paid Conversion Benchmarks

Model / Platform	Conversion Rate	Context
Cursor AI	36 %	360K paying / 1M users — fastest-growing SaaS ever
Free trial (with card)	~43 %	Industry average — credit card required
Free trial (no card)	~14 %	Industry average — no card barrier
SaaS free trials (broad)	~29 %	Cross-industry benchmark
Freemium model (general)	~4.2 %	Typical for mass-market freemium
GitHub Copilot	3.1 %	4.7M paid / 150M GitHub users
Microsoft M365 Copilot	3.3 %	15M paid / 450M M365 seats
ChatGPT (all weekly actives)	~1.7 %	~15M paid / 900M weekly actives

Sources: Backlinko ChatGPT Statistics 2026; The Register (Microsoft earnings); GetPanto GitHub Copilot Statistics; RevenueCat State of Subscription Apps 2026.

\$8.90/mo ChatGPT Blended ARPU (+19 % YoY)	\$25 B OpenAI Annualised Revenue (Feb 2026)	~\$3 B → \$14 B Anthropic ARR (2025 → 2026 est.)
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9. AI Coding Assistants

The AI coding assistant market has become one of the most competitive segments in the AI industry. **62 % of professional developers** now use an AI coding tool; **41 % of all code written in 2025** was AI-generated or AI-assisted. The market is valued at **\$6.8–\$7.4 B** in 2025 and projected to reach **\$30 B by 2032**.

Tool	Users / Scale	ARR (2026)	Market Share	"Most Loved"
GitHub Copilot (Microsoft)	20M cumulative users 4.7M paid subscribers	\$1 B+	~42 %	9 %
Cursor AI (Anysphere)	1M+ DAU 360K paying (36% CVR)	\$2 B+	~18 %	19 %
Claude Code (Anthropic)	#1 most-used agent 71% of agentic-AI devs	\$1–2.5 B	Top 3	46 %
Windsurf (Cognition AI)	1M+ active users 350+ enterprise customers	\$82 M*	Small	—
Replit AI	35–40M total users 750K businesses	\$265 M	~5 %	—
Amazon Q Developer	Not disclosed 50K Accenture devs	N/A	~4 %	—
Tabnine	1M+ users	N/A	~1–5 %	—

* Acquired by Cognition AI (July 2025) for ~\$250M; Google licensed tech for ~\$2.4B. "Most Loved" from Pragmatic Engineer Survey (15K devs, Feb 2026). Sources: GetPanto; TechCrunch; Gradually.ai Claude Code Statistics 2026.

Claude Code Highlights

- Launched as limited preview Feb 2025; GA May 2025. Reached **\$1 B annualised revenue faster than any AI coding tool in history**.
- **46 % "most loved" rating** — far ahead of Cursor (19 %) and GitHub Copilot (9 %) among 15,000 surveyed developers.
- **95 % first-try code correctness** — highest among tested AI coding agents.
- Used internally at Microsoft, Google, and OpenAI.
- Accounts for **~10 % of Anthropic's total revenue**; estimated \$2–2.5 B run rate by early 2026.

10. Other AI Tools: Image, Video, Audio & Productivity

Image Generation

Tool	Users / Scale	Revenue (2025)	Market Share
Midjourney	19–21M registered; 1.2–2.5M DAU	~\$500M	26.8 %
DALL-E (OpenAI)	916M images created (cumul. 2024)	via ChatGPT	24.4 %
Stable Diffusion (open source)	12.59B images total (80% of all AI images) 10M+ users across platforms	N/A (open)	Dominant (OS ecosystem)
Adobe Firefly	24B assets generated by May 2025 75% of Fortune 500	\$400M (2024–25)	Enterprise leader

Sources: DemandSage Midjourney Statistics 2026; Quantumrun Stable Diffusion & Adobe Firefly Stats.

Video & Audio AI

Tool	Users / Scale	Revenue / Valuation	Notes
Runway ML	300K customers (all major film studios)	\$300M rev \$5.3B valuation	Gen-4.5 = #1 Video Arena; raised \$308M Apr 2025
OpenAI Sora	~3.3M downloads; 8M+ videos	Shut down Mar 24, 2026	Unsustainable GPU costs; compute reallocated to GPT-5
ElevenLabs (Audio AI)	1M+ users; 250K+ AI agents 60% of Fortune 500	\$100M ARR \$11B valuation	Raised \$500M Feb 2026; 70+ languages; IPO targeted

Sources: Sacra Runway; Fueler ElevenLabs Statistics 2026; VO3 AI Sora Shutdown Report.

Productivity & Companion AI

Tool	Users	Revenue	Notes
Grammarly AI	30–40M DAU; 70K orgs 96% of Fortune 500	\$700M ARR	GrammarlyGO powered by GPT-4 + Claude; \$13B valuation
Notion AI	100M total users 4M+ paying	\$400M (2024)	5× growth since 2022; AI bundled into Business/Enterprise plans
Character.AI	~20M MAU 194M website visitors/mo	\$32M (2024)	17min avg session (2× ChatGPT); 51% aged 18–24
Replika (AI companion)	30M registered ~2M MAU	~\$24M (2024)	70% users report reduced loneliness; 2.7 hrs/day avg engagement

Sources: ElectrolQ Grammarly Statistics; Super.so Notion Statistics 2026; DemandSage Character.AI Statistics; NikolaRoza Replika Statistics 2026.

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